

MATYA STAVNITZKY

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF WATERLOO

Master of Mathematics (MMath), Computer Science. Supervisor: Daniel Vogel

Waterloo, Ontario

2026 – 2028

MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY

B.A. Honors Cognitive Science, B.Sc. Computer Science

Minors in Math, Philosophy and Geographical Information Systems.

Cumulative GPA 4.3/4.3, Majorie Young Bell Scholar, Dean's List

Sackville, New Brunswick

2022 – 2026

GUELPH COLLEGIATE VOCATIONAL INSTITUTE

International Baccalaureate program. Average above 90%.

Guelph, Ontario

2018 - 2022

SCHOLARSHIPS

- Canada Graduate Research Scholarship - Master's (NSERC): \$27,000 2026
- UW President's Scholarship (UNIVERSITY OF WATERLOO): \$5,000 2026
- Ontario Graduate Scholarship(OGS) (PROVINCIAL, DECLINED FOR NSERC CGS-D): \$15,000 2026
- Undergraduate Research Fellowship (UNIVERSITY OF WATERLOO): \$7,500 2025
- Undergraduate Student Research Award (NSERC): \$6,000 2025
- Marjorie Young Bell Scholarship(MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY): \$56,000 2022-2026

AWARDS

- Best Student Poem (TANTRAMAR POETRY CONTEST) 2026
- Jeff "Skip" Fraser Memorial Scholarship (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY): \$450 2025
- Best Talk (2SLGBTQ+ IN STEM CONFERENCE) 2025
- 3rd Team (ATLANTIC CANADA PROGRAMING CONTEST) 2025
- Best Student Poem (TANTRAMAR POETRY CONTEST) 2025
- Top 5 Novice Debater (CUSID EAST ATLANTIC CHAMPIONSHIPS) 2025
- 3rd Team (ATLANTIC CANADA PROGRAMING CONTEST) 2024
- 3rd Team in Atlantic Canada (ICPC NA EAST DIVISION) 2024
- Chase-Oxely Prize (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY PHILOSOPHY DEPT.): \$100 2023
- 3rd Team in Atlantic Canada (ICPC NA EAST DIVISION) 2023
- Treash Memorial Prize (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY PHILOSOPHY DEPT.): \$100 2022
- Teacher's Award (GUELPH COLLEGIATE VOCATIONAL INSTITUTE) 2022
- Loran Scholarship Semi-Finalist (LORAN SCHOLARS) 2021

WORK EXPERIENCE

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH FELLOW (UNIVERSITY OF WATERLOO)

2025

Supervisor: Dr. Daniel Vogel. NSERC Undergraduate Student Research Award (USRA) and Undergraduate Research Fellowship (URF) recipient. Independent research on the impact of photography interfaces on memory.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY)

2024 - 2025

Supervisor: Dr. Genevieve Desmarais. Research on the Colavita visual dominance effect: a phenomenon where responses to visual stimuli are stronger than auditory stimuli when both are observed. Responsible for data collection.

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH FELLOW (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY)

2024

Supervisor: Dr. Laurie Ricker. Independent research on the application of Reinforcement Learning in Decentralized Discrete-Event Systems. This research was presented at the Science Atlantic Math, Statistics, and Computer Science Conference (MSCS).

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- TEACHING ASSISTANT** (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY) 2023 - 2026
Responsible for marking, providing in-class support, and one-on-one teaching. Teaching experience in: Introduction to Computer Science, Linear Algebra, Statistical Methods, Computer Science Help Center, Data Science Help Center, Introduction to the Philosophy of Science, Introductory Logic
- COMMUNITY ACTIVITY ORGANIZER** (GUELPH NEIGHBORHOOD SUPPORT COALITION) 2021 - 2022
Independently developed and implemented interactive programming for community events around Guelph. Advertising community events through online and traditional methods leading to attendance of 10 to 200 people depending on the event.
- RICKSON CAMP LEADER** (GUELPH NEIGHBORHOOD SUPPORT COALITION) SUMMER 2020, 2021, 2022
Assisted in supervising 60 children ages 3-12. Responsible for independently organizing and leading covid adapted activities.

TRAINING PROGRAMS AND CERTIFICATIONS

- THE QUANTUM NEXUS RESEARCH PROJECT** (CIGI / DND MINDS) 2026
Strategic policy initiative developing risk-management frameworks for dual-use technologies, analyzing the intersection of quantum computing and artificial intelligence, and formulating national security recommendations for Canadian intellectual property and supply chain defense.
- TECH GOVERNANCE SUMMER SCHOOL** (BALSILLIE SCHOOL OF INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS) 2026
Two-week program exploring the technology-policy nexus, digital transformation, and global regulatory frameworks through expert lectures, case studies, and policy exercises.
- PHILOSOPHY SUMMER INSTITUTE** (CANADIAN PHILOSOPHICAL ASSOCIATION) 2024
One-week enrichment program for philosophy undergraduates from across Canada. I was one of 17 participants selected.
- AI4GOOD** (AI4GOOD LAB) 2023
Selected as one of 90 participants from over 250 applicants (acceptance rate ~36%) to participate in this full-time machine learning training program.

RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

- INVESTIGATING THE EFFECTS OF PHOTOGRAPHY ON RECALL**
CHI EA 2026
Stavnitzky, M., Vogel, D., Nikhita, J.
- ON EXPERTS AND ALGORITHMS: WHO DECIDES WHEN AI DECIDES?**
UNDERGRADUATE THESIS 2026
Stavnitzky, M.
- REINFORCEMENT LEARNING AND THE CONTROL OF DECENTRALIZED DISCRETE-EVENT SYSTEMS**
SCIENCE ATLANTIC MATH, STATISTICS, AND COMPUTER SCIENCE CONFERENCE 2024
Stavnitzky, M., Ricker, L.

CLUBS

PRESIDENT MATH AND COMPUTER SOCIETY (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY) 2025 - 2026

Led a 6-member executive team to plan, promote, and execute a diverse calendar of academic and social events. Strategized campus outreach to build an inclusive community, consistently driving engagement and drawing up to 100+ attendees per event.

CO-PRESIDENT COGNITIVE SCIENCE SOCIETY (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY) 2025 - 2026

Co-managed community-building events and developed a strategic social media posting schedule to maximize campus visibility. Successfully mobilized the student body, achieving a remarkable 70% program-wide participation rate through targeted digital communication.

CO-PRESIDENT MTA HACKATHON (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY) 2024 - 2025

Directed a 5-person committee to organize a major weekend conference for students across East Coast Canada, securing over \$2,000 in funding. Managed end-to-end event logistics and digital promotion to attract and engage 40+ active participants.

PHOTOGRAPHER MAGICIANS GUILD (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY) 2023 - 2025

Captured and edited high-quality event photography to serve as the primary visual assets for organization-wide promotional campaigns.

CO-PRESIDENT RESPONSIBLE AI CLUB (MOUNT ALLISON UNIVERSITY) 2023 - 2024

Co-led educational campaigns and community dialogues addressing the ethical and societal impacts of emerging technologies. Translated complex concepts into accessible, engaging digital and in-person discussions for a broad audience.

EDITOR YEARBOOK (GUELPH COLLEGIATE VOCATIONAL INSTITUTE) 2023 - 2025

Managed a creative team of 30+ individuals to direct the visual strategy, copywriting, and end-to-end media production of a major publication. Maintained strict project timelines while overseeing page layout design and photography workflows to ensure cohesive storytelling.

VOLUNTEER WORK

- **FAMILY CAMP (6 years)**

A summer camp designed to encourage and provide a vacation experience for families that experience disability. Responsible for supporting a camper living with a disability.

- **SEXUAL VIOLENCE PREVENTION TEAM (2 years)**

Facilitating outreach and education programs that connect students with sexual violence resources on campus.

- **SMILE CLUB (2 years)**

A gym and swim program for children with disabilities. Organized games in a group setting.

- **COMMUNITY CONNECT (2 years)**

A program that aims to build community and reduce the isolation of seniors. Responsible for planning and attending weekly meetings.

- **STUDENT REFUGEE PROGRAM (1 year)**

A club that provides support for refugee students at Mount Allison University. Responsible for providing academic advising.

SKILLS

Organization, Problem Solving, Programming (Python, Java, JavaScript, C, C++)